Tesla Model Y L Delivery Checklist

The following is a distillation of posts from `r/TeslaModelY`, `r/ModelYL`, `r/ModelY`, and `r/TeslaLounge`. The list is not meant to replace Tesla's QC and thus doesn't offer 100% coverage. Rather, these contributions from Model Y and Model Y L owners who already walked the path aim to cover recurring problems that unfortunately seem to escape quality control (QC) at the factory as well as at the service centers.

This document is based off of the work from polymorphic/tesla-model-y-checklist.

Use it to guide your inspection, document findings, assemble a list of problems to be handled by Tesla as pre-delivery issue(s) or refuse delivery.

Not all issues can be inspected without unlocking the vehicle. Unless the service center staff offers to unlock your vehicle, you cannot do so prior to accepting delivery on your phone. To facilitate making that decision the list works from the outside of the car in: it begins with a walk-around of the locked car (front, sides, wheels, rear, underneath), then covers what you can check from the outside once it's unlocked (lights, glass, doors, charge port, frunk, liftgate), and finishes inside the cabin, from the front row back to the cargo area. A few things can only be checked on your first drive; those come last.

Since you are inspecting a vehicle for issues, and issues can be dangerous, be careful. Do not stick your fingers between exterior panels or anywhere else you cannot visually inspect.

This checklist requires at least 90 minutes to complete.

Before You Buy

Ensure that you buy the car at the location you intend to pick up. Working with a showroom sales representative means that the rep is not on the ground and they are unable to inspect the vehicle themselves before selling it to you. Sales requests are simply forwarded to the pickup location and any personal details or requests are lost in the handoff.

Screenshot your order page, including the full feature list, when you order. Tesla changed the Launch Series feature wording after orders were placed (1), and the screenshot is your evidence if something is missing at delivery.

Tesla sometimes reassigns the VIN a few days before pickup. If that happens, update your insurance: Tesla needs proof of coverage for that specific car (1).

For payment, Tesla takes wire transfers and cashier's checks but not personal checks. Linking your bank account in the app (through Plaid) completes the payment step, and one owner waited to send the money until after inspecting the car (1). Another owner was told to pay at least 7 days before delivery, so ask your delivery center which applies (2).

If you finance through Tesla, the credit approval lasts only 30 to 60 days. When delivery slips past it, you reapply at current rates and Tesla pulls your credit again; one owner who applied the day the financing task opened got a higher APR the second time. Owners have been told to wait until they have a VIN before applying. Some advisors promise to honor the original rate, so get that in writing (1, 2).

Treat the delivery appointment as tentative, even after the car has arrived. Owners have had appointments cancelled the morning of pickup, or an hour before, because the car was still in transit or hadn't been built yet, even after paying in full and starting insurance. Rescheduled dates were described as placeholders, and some owners had

their VIN pulled and were left without a new date (1, 2, 3). One Model Y owner's confirmed pickup slid back a day at a time for a week while the car sat at the delivery center, waiting on a California regulatory approval (4).

If you're trading in a car, take your license plates, toll tag, garage door opener, and personal items out of it before you hand it over. Owners at factory pickup had their trade-ins taken away with the plates still on; Tesla offered to dispose of them, but some states require plates to be surrendered to the DMV (1).

Exterior

Locked

ORDER DETAILS

- [ ] Vehicle VIN matches the assigned VIN and the VIN on your insurance card
- [ ] Color is as ordered
- [ ] Wheel style is as ordered (19" wheel or 20" Uberhelix wheel).
- [ ] A sleeve with *two* keys is provided

FRONT

- [ ] Check the head light fit
- [ ] Inspect the front bumper for scrapes and gouges, including the paint around the intake vents and the bumper's lower edge. Two Model Y Ls parked at a California delivery center had badly gouged front bumpers and scuffs on other panels, which the poster blamed on rough handling in transport (1)
- [ ] Inspect the frunk, look for paint defects, dents and signs of improper closing by the sides of the T logo
- [ ] Make sure the hood sits flush with the quarter panels and frunk
- [ ] Inspect that the windshield is installed properly (gaps between the glass and A pillar on either side should be approximately equal). An improperly installed windshield causes significant wind noise at highway speeds.

SIDES AND BODY

- [ ] Check for uneven/wide panel gaps and that panels are flush to car, including around the doors, trunk arms, and roof
- [ ] Inspect the paint on the outside, ensure panel corners do not have chips. Look for dust or specks trapped under the clear coat, especially on the fenders (1, 2)

  > **Fix:** light scratches in the clear coat can be buffed out on site; one owner's were before they left (1). Dust under the clear coat needs a service appointment.

- [ ] Look for signs that a panel was repainted before delivery: overspray on trim, seals, or glass, polishing compound in panel seams or light lenses, or a panel whose finish doesn't match its neighbors. One owner's PPF installer found a poorly repainted rear panel two weeks after pickup, and Tesla said there was nothing it could do (1). Ask whether the car was repaired before delivery. California requires dealers to disclose in writing any repaired damage that cost more than 3% of MSRP or $500, whichever is greater; a replaced bolt-on part such as a bumper counts toward that only for its paint (§ 9990, § 9991)
- [ ] Check that the trim along the bottom of the sides of the vehicle are flush with the bottom of the doors
- [ ] Check for trim stains
- [ ] Check all 4 door levers

- [ ] Check for dings on pillars
- [ ] Check for damage to black rocker panels
- [ ] Check charging port fit (driver's side)
- [ ] Inspect the glass roof for scratches, chips, and even alignment

> **Fix:** Tesla offered to replace the roof glass for a scratch an owner found after delivery (1)
> **Normal:** the untinted strip at the rear of the glass roof is left uncoated so antenna signals can get through (1)

WHEELS AND TIRES

- [ ] Ensure wheels are not scratched or dented (1, 2)
- [ ] Ensure there is nothing lodged in the tires (screws, nails, debris, etc.)
- [ ] Confirm all 4 hubcaps are present and properly attached
- [ ] Inspect all wheel wells. Each wheel well is fitted with noise dampener covers that are attached to the body with a combination of plastic pins (pushed in all the way) and metal threaded pins (sticking out) with plastic nuts. Confirm that all plastic pins are present (there are no empty holes) and all metal pins (2 in each front wheel well, 4 in each rear wheel well) are present and properly attached.

> **Photo:** threaded pins with and without plastic nuts
> **Fix:** mobile service can fix it in minutes

REAR

- [ ] Check the tail light fit

> **Photo:** Tail light (passenger side) not flush with panel
> **Fix:** Not yet available

- [ ] Check that the liftgate sits evenly, with matching gaps on both sides (1)
- [ ] Inspect the tail lights for condensation
- [ ] Check for tow hitch if you included it on your order.

UNDERNEATH

- [ ] Inspect the undercarriage, look for scratches, dents, damage, missing components, missing screws, or screws that are sticking out

> **Photo:** Undercarriage screw found sticking out, not fully tightened
> **Fix:** Requires a 10mm wrench; ask the service center staff to inspect all screws and clips (they should've done it already)

Unlocked

LIGHTS AND WIPERS

- [ ] Turn on the lights including: fog lights, headlights, tail lights, reverse light, brake lights, headlight signal, and side signal lights
- [ ] Check that wipers function correctly, without a loud click on each wipe, and look for potential wiper dings on hood (1)

- [ ] Spray the washer fluid, then look for a low-fluid warning on the screen and for fluid dripping under the front of the car. One owner's reservoir leaked a gallon of fluid onto the ground after a refill, and another owner's tank arrived cracked (1)

  > **Fix:** replace the reservoir (one owner's tank, pump, and assembly were replaced as an assembly defect)

GLASS

- [ ] Inspect all glass for ripples, distortion, scratches, or cracks

DOORS

- [ ] Close each door with normal force and confirm it fully latches, with no door-open alert on the screen. The doors aren't soft-close like on the Model S and X, so they need a firm push, but they shouldn't need a slam. Rear doors are the most common offender (1, 2).

  > **Fix:** striker adjustment; some service centers did it on site in about 10 minutes, otherwise mobile service

- [ ] Verify that the rubber seal is properly attached to the bottom of all 4 doors.

  > **Photo:** rubber seal loose on driver door bottom
  > **Fix:** service center, replace rubber seal (Tesla calls it a "secondary seal")

- [ ] Inspect the weather seals around door gaps and windows
- [ ] Inspect the paint in the door jams, ensure there are no chips
- [ ] Check for trim scratches on windows due to a software bug that doesn't automatically lower the window when opening the door

CHARGE PORT

- [ ] Verify that the charge port opens and closes
- [ ] Confirm (car battery) charging works
- [ ] Express Pickup: Check the charge of the vehicle. It comes from the factory at ~50% but the local distributor should charge it to 80%-90% for a "full tank."

FRUNK

- [ ] Open and close the frunk
- [ ] Verify the clips holding the trim area around the frunk
- [ ] Check the frunk lighting
- [ ] Confirm that the tow hook is included

LIFTGATE

- [ ] Open & close the lift gate; sometimes the weather seal gets caught in the molding, causing a click
- [ ] Confirm the lift gate opens and closes without "shuddering" and that the button on the hatch works to close it
- [ ] Test power liftgate operation and height adjustment
- [ ] Verify water guards below the rear windshield are clear

Interior

Front row

- [ ] Inspect the screen for scratches, phantom touches and dead pixels (use the Sketchpad app)
- [ ] Inspect the dash for scratches
- [ ] Launch Series: the dashboard wing matches your order. The suede wing comes only with the black interior; Zen Gray interiors get fabric (1, 2). The door inserts below the ambient light strip follow the same pattern (3)
- [ ] Check that the ambient light strip lines up where it runs from the dash into each front door, and compare the two sides. One owner's passenger-side strip sat visibly lower than the dash section (1)

  > **Normal:** owners of the refreshed Model Y and Model 3 report the same offset, and most commenters called it within spec

- [ ] Inspect the center console for scratches, dings, etc.
- [ ] With the passenger seat empty, open and close the center armrest and watch for it rubbing the seat. It did on one Model Y Performance, and on another Performance at the same service center (1)

  > **Normal:** service called the rubbing normal and said seat wear from it is cosmetic and not covered by the warranty. Sliding the passenger seat or seatback back stops it

- [ ] Inspect the steering wheel, check front and back for scratches or tears
- [ ] Inspect the headliner all around (no grease, damage or scuffs)
- [ ] Look for scratches on door sills
- [ ] Check seats for scuffs, damage, and bad seams
- [ ] Verify all front seat adjustments, including lumbar support, and lean side to side to confirm the seat doesn't shift on its frame. One Model Y owner's driver seat did, and it got worse until service flagged it as a safety issue (1)
- [ ] Confirm seat warmers work
- [ ] Inspect the floor mats for rips, stains, etc.
- [ ] Inspect the metal accelerator and brake pedal arms; there have been reports of different finish on pedals (matte on accelerator, glossy on brake) and a conspicuous weld in the middle of the brake pedal
- [ ] Validate doors appropriately unlatch via the door open switch. All four doors should behave the same way; one owner had a single door that, after a gentle close, locked and wouldn't release from the button (1)

Controls and electronics

- [ ] Check the alerts on the screen; there should be no active warnings
- [ ] Launch Series: check the Software screen for Acceleration Boost. Owners who took delivery in September and October report it missing, though demo cars at delivery centers show it, and others point out that Tesla never listed it as included. Compare against your order screenshot (1, 2, 3, 4)
- [ ] Check that turn signal and drive selection stalks work and actuate smoothly
- [ ] Check that the car can be put into reverse, neutral, park

- [ ] Open and close windows using one click open close and manually open and close (make sure there are no noises and they stay up when you close, and when they go down they do all the way down for front two windows. The rear two windows don't go down all the way.
- [ ] Fold mirrors
- [ ] Verify backup camera, Park Assist sensor, and Blind Spot camera. Open each camera view and look for a foggy or cloudy image, especially from the fender (side repeater) cameras. One owner's driver-side fender camera was hazy and kept triggering a camera-obstructed warning that cleaning didn't clear; service said several cars had come in with the same problem (1, 2)

  > **Fix:** camera replacement at the service center. Afterward, confirm that camera calibration finishes. One Model Y owner's mobile repair installed the wrong camera, which disabled FSD and cruise control until a second repair, and calibration still showed incomplete 140 miles later (2)

- [ ] Check all interior lights, and that all reading lights turn on with a press
  - [ ] Puddle lights, door pocket lighting, overhead lights, etc.
  - [ ] Check steering wheel control lights
- [ ] Open and close the glovebox
  - [ ] Make sure USB drive for Sentry Mode / Dashcam is present
- [ ] Verify that wireless charging works on both sides and the phone connects
- [ ] Confirm wired charging works on every USB-C port (2 in front, 2 in back) and test the 12V receptacle
- [ ] Test the HVAC system: turn on climate control, force the heat pump to kick in by taking the temperature to either end of the scale and listen for loud noises
- [ ] Play a familiar track through the sound system and confirm that all speakers work (use the balance and fader controls) and there are no unexpected clicks, etc.

Second and third rows

- [ ] Inspect both coat hooks (should extend, retract and latch)
- [ ] Confirm that the second-row captain's chairs recline correctly
- [ ] Buckle each second- and third-row seat belt and confirm it pulls out and retracts smoothly. One owner's captain's chair belts locked as soon as they were buckled (1)
- [ ] Verify third row seats work correctly

  > **Normal:** the third-row headrests stay down after the seats power up; raise them by hand (1)

- [ ] Third-row floor mats aren't included. Tesla all-weather liners ordered with the car ship separately, about a week after delivery (1). Remove the carpet mats before fitting them. Even then, two owners' driver-side liners left a half-inch gap at the door sill, and one owner's third-row liners lifted at the corners when the seats folded (2)
- [ ] Inspect the back seat covers and verify they're properly attached
- [ ] Ensure the bottom of the back seats is securely attached.

Cargo area

- [ ] Check the trunk lighting (there are 2 trunk lights)
- [ ] Inspect the cargo covers and verify they're properly attached
- [ ] Confirm that seat & trunk buttons fold the back seats

- [ ] Confirm folding rear seats do not catch on the rear trunk floor carpeting
- [ ] Confirm the J1772 adapter isn't missing
- [ ] Confirm the V2L outlet adapter is included (1)
- [ ] Check for Front License plate holder.

First drive

You can't drive the car before accepting delivery, so check these on the way home and report anything within the delivery window (see What next?).

- [ ] The steering wheel is centered when driving straight, and the car tracks straight without pulling or a delayed response to small steering inputs (1)

  > **Fix:** alignment adjustment at the service center

- [ ] Get on the highway early. Feel for tire vibration or wheel imbalance, and listen for wind whistle around the doors and mirrors (1, 2)

  > **Fix:** one owner traced a passenger-door whistle to the triangle trim next to the mirror; open a service request

- [ ] Listen for rattles and creaks, especially from the dash, the rear seats, and the front suspension over bumps. Before you book service for a dash rattle, check the storage bins: one owner's rattle turned out to be the loose wheel-cover removal tool (1, 2)

  > **Fix:** can take several tries. One Model Y owner was on a third service visit for a rear-seat rattle and a front suspension creak (2)

- [ ] Watch for warnings that appear once you're moving. One owner's safety restraint system error showed up 20 minutes into the drive home (1)

  > **Fix:** service traced it to a faulty left body wiring harness. The part had to be ordered and the repair meant taking the interior apart; the owner drove a loaner while they waited

Final thoughts about your delivery inspection

Please don't be "that guy" that blocks Tesla deliveries and staff for hours while going over your new car with a microscope! You can report all of the above after you get home, within the reporting window (see What next?). It’s not like you won’t accept the car because of some minor issue that can be fixed by a mobile service tech later (but won’t be fixed at pickup). Visit and check the local super charger while you are there, too.

Photograph every panel, wheel, and the interior before you drive off. If something shows up later, such as paint that starts lifting a couple of days after delivery, the photos show it wasn't there at pickup (1). Have the staff write down anything you find, as one owner did with a list of panel and trim misalignments (2). A delivery advisor's word doesn't bind service, though: one owner's advisor called a rubbing armrest a defect and booked a repair, and service later called it normal (3).

Better yet, if you can, pick up the car in person at an express checkout site. Assuming all of your affairs are in order via the website, Tesla will park your car in their lot and put your name on it. You simply sign the paperwork they

leave on the dash, deposit the paperwork in a bin, and drive off. This allows you all the time you require to inspect the vehicle before deciding to accept the car or not. Do note that the express checkout is often staffed by temporary hires or other low-level staff as their only function is to shuffle the cars around and ensure the proper paperwork awaits you. Any problems that might arise they will simply ask you to schedule an appointment to come back in with the vehicle. Plan accordingly: do not pickup the vehicle at dusk and have to examine everything in darkness.

Factory pickups (such as Giga Texas) happen in an open lot, often in the heat. Cars can arrive with fine factory dust in the crevices and on the door sills, which can hide scratches, so bring a microfiber cloth. If it's raining, ask for a covered or indoor spot before you start (1, 2, 3). Budget extra time: system errors linking the temporary tag or setting up the phone key held owners up from 30 minutes to two hours (1, 2).

This car is quite expensive. Make sure it is absolutely what you want before you accept delivery. With the recent push to "make the numbers," Tesla is selling cars at a faster clip than they are staffing up at. Wait times to get issues resolved later might be long: Model Y L owners report first available service appointments three to four weeks out (1, 2). If the first slot is weeks away, ask the scheduler to check other nearby service centers; one owner got in three days later that way (3).

What next?

Should anything escape factory quality control, service center quality control, and the above checklist here are some options to be aware of:

- If the quality of the car is inadequate you can **refuse delivery**. There have been several refused delivery reports (1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7), check out the threads for details. Following that, you should be assigned a new VIN. One owner refused a car with a smashed roof and got a better one on the second try; another was told they had to accept a car with paint damage, dents, a dented rim, and misaligned doors, then spent two weeks in the shop and later learned that wasn't true in California (1).
- Once you accept the car, expect a **repair, not a replacement**. An owner whose window shattered the day after pickup (a failed window motor) asked about exchanging the car and got a free repair instead. Keep a record of all communication with Tesla: app messages, call logs, and in-person conversations (1). Also log the days the car spends in service, which count toward a lemon-law claim in many states (2).
- After leaving the lot you have 72 hours or 100 miles to **report delivery issues to be fixed free of charge**. The 72 hours refers to items subject to "wear and tear," such as paint defects, scratches, etc. Any item that would normally be covered under warranty is still covered under warranty, but things like blemishes, scratches, dings, scuffs, aren't covered by any other car company. An owner who reported quarter-panel paint damage long after delivery was quoted about $1,000 CAD to fix it (1). However, check this thread about a problem reported within the first 7 days of ownership and being asked to accept a cost estimate.

  > **Note:** the information about refusing delivery and reporting delivery issues has been contributed by several people. I couldn't find the authoritative source; pointers appreciated.

The first week

- **FSD miles not recorded** If the FSD mileage stat stays at 0, switch to Traffic-Aware Cruise Control and back while parked, or reboot the screen by holding both scroll wheels (1, 2, 3).

- **Camera calibration** FSD can be unavailable for a while after pickup while the cameras calibrate; one owner lost it for a few hours. That's normal. A camera-obstructed warning that won't clear after cleaning the lens is not (see the camera item under Controls and electronics) (1). Neither is FSD dropping out days later: one Model Y Performance lost it after 10 days, and service replaced a camera and then the car's computer (2).
- **Liftgate height** The Model Y L's liftgate is taller than the Model Y's and can hit a low garage ceiling. Set the opening height before you open it in the garage (1).
- **Wheel & Tire Protection** If it's missing from the app under Upgrades > Service Plans, Tesla has told owners the option appears closer to the 14-day enrollment deadline (1). The tires are staggered (different sizes front and rear), and the rears need a specific load rating that some tire shops don't stock. One owner paid $530 at Tesla for a 19" rear tire after a flat in the first two weeks (2).
- **FSD and curbs** Several owners report FSD clipping curbs on tight right turns in their first days, and curb rash isn't covered. Be ready to take over on tight turns (1).

Ownership beyond the first 1,000 miles

Making it past the above milestones doesn't mean that service center visits or mobile service appointments are a thing of the past. Remaining problems caused by quality control issues might be covered by Tesla's New Vehicle Warranty, which for Long Range and Performance Model Ys is 8 years or 120,000 miles. Here are a few things to keep an eye on:

- **Door rubber seals** Keep an eye on the seals, particularly on the door bottoms (see Doors under Exterior > Unlocked).
- **Tail light condensation** Wide temperature changes (such as when leaving the vehicle parked in the sun) may cause condensation to appear in the rear tail lights. Should that happen fairly evenly across all 4 lights Tesla won't do anything about it. You may have better luck if it's asymmetric so keep an eye for that.
- **Trim liner** Poor quality adhesive, bad adhesive application, or a combination of both could cause trim liner pieces glued to the trim to come off. For example, here's the liner peeling off from the lift gate trim after only a couple of months. Keep an eye on glued parts and schedule service for anything that's coming loose.

Pull requests for changes and additions welcome.